

Moving to Japan: first 30 days checklist

A boring, practical order for bank, phone, bills, and apartment setup in month one.

Week 1: legal address and basics

- ☐ Register residence at city hall within the legal window. Bring passport and lease proof.
- ☐ Receive residence card updates if applicable. Photograph front and back, store offline.
- ☐ National Health Insurance enrollment often follows the same visit or soon after.

Week 2: money and connectivity

- ☐ Open a bank account if your visa status allows. Ask which ATMs and apps work overseas.
- ☐ SIM or MVNO plan that matches your stay length. Home internet quote if fiber install waits weeks.
- ☐ My Number card invitation may arrive by mail. Track mail slots and names on the box.

Week 3: apartment and utilities

- ☐ Electric, gas, and water start dates aligned with key handover. Photos of meters on day one.
- ☐ Garbage ward chart on the fridge. Wrong bag day is a common early fine risk.
- ☐ Fire insurance proof if your building requires it for renewal.

Week 4: habits and buffers

- ☐ Auto debit for rent and utilities once the bank confirms timing.
- ☐ Emergency cash buffer separate from daily wallet.
- ☐ One folder for scanned leases, visa papers, and insurance PDFs.